3 Note from Judith Merril: The whole point to this incident is contained in Isaac's understated phrase, "making gallant suggestions to the ladies." The fact is that Isaac (who was at that time a spectacularly uxorious and virtuous husband) apparently felt obliged to leer, ogle, pat, and proposition as an act of sociability. When it went, occasionally, beyond purely social enjoyability, there seemed no way to clue him in.

Let me pause to make clear that I am neither impugning Isaac's desirability nor claiming any extraordinary maidenliness for myself. Unattached as I then was, had I for a moment believed in the seriousness of his intent, I might well have been agreeable. As it was, however, I felt certain I would not be called upon to make any decisions about my own seriousness, when I carefully and with malice aforehand created this situation.

A parallel incident that occurred about the same time at a Hydra Club party at the Lotos Club seems to have escaped the famous Asimov memory. [No, it hasn't. LA.] Asimov was known in those days, to various women, as "the man with a hundred hands." On this occasion, the third or fourth time his hand patted my rear end, I reached out to clutch his crotch. He never manhandled me in vain again.

"I don't care where you are/' said Horace. "You're a grown man. You can be anywhere you want to be."

"No. I'm really at my mother-in-law's. Mary/' I called, "come here and say hello to Mr. Gold."

Mary, completely mystified as to what was going on, said, "Hello" into the phone and then said to me, predictably, "What's going on?"

"Did you hear that, Horace?" I asked, urgently.

And he said, cozily, "I told you, Isaac, I don't care where you are. Judy doesn't have to change her voice." And he hung up and left me frustrated.

(Of course, my worries were needless. In the first place, I was completely innocent. And even if I were not, it was silly of me to think that anyone in science fiction would take note of any amorous event, however illicit. The thing was too common to do anything but yawn over.)

On the twenty-fourth, I visited Brad and Marty Greenberg, and from the figures they gave me, it seemed that my five novels had already sold some 30,000 copies in hard-cover, with Pebble in the Sky, which had now been on